

NAPCS Unionization Research — State — Charter Sector Overview

Indiana — IEERB/NLRB R25 Jurisdiction — June 6, 2026 [RESEARCH DEFERRED]

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Section 1: State Overview

State	Indiana
Labor Board	IEERB/NLRB R25 — Indiana Education Employment Relations Board / National Labor Relations Board, Region 25 (Indianapolis)
Governing Law	Ind. Code §20-24 (Charter Schools). Ind. Code §20-24-6 — charter teachers are at-will employees of the charter school. IEERB has jurisdiction over public employers; independently operated charters may fall under NLRB R25. Jurisdiction unsettled.
Federal NLRB Jurisdiction	YES — Jurisdiction split — some IN charters may be public employers under IEERB; independently operated charters likely NLRB R25. Jurisdictional analysis required per school.
Right-to-Work	Right-to-Work State — Ind. Code §22-6-6
For-Profit Operator Status	For-profit EMO management contracts permitted under state law
Card-Check Available	NO — RTW state; no card-check statute.
Research Status	DEFERRED — Executive Sponsor direction, June 7, 2026 (PDR-018). Sector assumed unorganized. No school-level research conducted.

Section 2: Charter Sector Landscape

Research deferred — Executive Sponsor direction (PDR-018, June 7, 2026). Sector assumed unorganized. Charter universe and enrollment figures are sourced from Charter School Registry v133 and NCES ELSI 2024–25. No school-level research has been conducted.

Category	Schools	% of Total	Notes
No Organizing Activity Documented	132	100%	Research deferred — Executive Sponsor direction (PDR-018, June 7, 2026). Sector assumed unorganized.
Total Charter Schools in Indiana	132	100%	Source: Charter School Registry v133 (NCES ELSI 2024–25).

Charter Sector Enrollment

Total Charter Enrollment	54,937 students — 5.3% of state K–12 enrollment (1,040,190 total K–12 students)
Students in CMO/EMO-Affiliated Charter Schools	N/A — research deferred; sector assumed unorganized
Students in Organized Charter Schools	N/A — research deferred; sector assumed unorganized
Data Sources	Charter enrollment: NCES ELSI 2024–25 / Charter School Registry v133. Total K–12 state enrollment: NCES ELSI 2024–25 (all public schools). Both figures from the same source and year.

Section 3: Charter Management Organizations & Education Management Organizations

Charter Management Organizations (CMOs) are nonprofit networks. Education Management Organizations (EMOs) are for-profit management companies. Data sourced from Charter School Registry v133. Union penetration reflects confirmed organized schools as of the data currency date.

CMO / EMO Name	Type	State Campuses	National Campuses †	Organized in State	Total Enrollment
Goodwill Excel Centers	Network‡	24	—	—	6,229
Phalen Leadership Academies Indiana	Network‡	6	—	—	1,951
KIPP Indianapolis	Network‡	3	—	—	1,442
Options Charter Schools	Network‡	3	—	—	1,043
Purdue Polytechnic High Schools	Network‡	3	—	—	967
Avondale Meadows	Network‡	2	—	—	524
Christel House Academies	Network‡	2	—	—	971
Circle City Prep Charter School	Network‡	2	—	—	418
TOTAL — All CMO/EMO Schools in Indiana		45		0 organized schools in network-affiliated charters	

† National Campuses reflects total campuses operated by this network across all states, as reported in Charter School Registry v133. Provides context for networks operating in multiple states.

‡ Network (type unclassified) = operator present in Charter School Registry v133 but not yet classified in CMO Reference data. Contact registry project to add classification for these records.

8 network (type unclassified). Approximately 87 schools operate independently with no CMO/EMO affiliation. Source: Charter School Registry v133.

Section 4: Legal Framework & Sector Overview

Findings are based on research as of June 6, 2026.

1: Legal & Jurisdictional Framework

Ind. Code §20-24 (Charter Schools). Ind. Code §20-24-6 — charter teachers are at-will employees of the charter school. IEERB has jurisdiction over public employers; independently operated charters may fall under NLRB R25. Jurisdiction unsettled. Indiana is a right-to-work state (Ind. Code §22-6-6). Charter schools in Indiana are subject to NLRB jurisdiction as private employers (IEERB/NLRB R25). Secret ballot NLRB election is the required organizing pathway. Card-check is not available.

2: Charter Sector Structure

Indiana operates 132 open-enrollment charter schools, enrolling approximately 54,937 students. 8 charter management organizations and education management organizations operate in Indiana. The largest networks by campus count are Goodwill Excel Centers (24 campuses in state), Phalen Leadership Academies Indiana (6 campuses in state), KIPP Indianapolis (3 campuses in state). Approximately 87 schools operate independently with no CMO or EMO affiliation. Network-level detail, including campus counts and total enrollment, appears in Section 3 above. No school-level union research has been conducted. Research deferred — Executive Sponsor direction (PDR-018, June 7, 2026).

Section 5: Media Coverage & Public Stakeholder Positions

Press Coverage

No press coverage of charter school employee organizing has been identified in Indiana. Charter sector coverage focuses on school accountability, urban enrollment patterns in Indianapolis, and CMO performance.

Legislative Context

No charter-sector collective bargaining legislation has been introduced in the Indiana General Assembly. Indiana enacted right-to-work legislation in 2012 (Ind. Code §22-6-6). Charter law amendments have addressed governance and accountability; labor relations are not addressed in Ind. Code §20-24.

Section 6: Contract & CBA Access Registry

No collective bargaining agreements documented for this state. Research deferred — sector assumed unorganized (PDR-018, June 7, 2026).